

The Ryokan That Wouldn't Let Us In

A short listening piece about a hotel, a long wait, and the five causative verbs — make, let, get, have, help. Don't read anything yet. Just press play.

STUDENT	DATE	TEACHER
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Listen with your teacher (or via the classroom link) before writing anything below. The audio plays twice: once for the story, once for detail.

TASK 1 · FIRST LISTEN

Answer in your own words — short answers are fine.

1. Why couldn't the guests check in right away?

2. What did the owner do instead of letting them into the room immediately?

3. How did the guest feel about the wait, by the end of the story?

TASK 2 · SECOND LISTEN

True or False?

1. True or False: The narrator arrived exactly at check-in time. (T) (F)

2. True or False: The owner refused to help them at all while they waited. (T) (F)

3. True or False: The room had a view of the garden. (T) (F)

4. True or False: The owner let them into the room as soon as they arrived. (T) (F)

5. True or False: The narrator ends the story frustrated about the wait. (T) (F)

VOCABULARY

ryokan

旅館

pousada tradicional japonesa

tatami

畳

esteira tradicional japonesa

check-in

チェックイン

registro de entrada

patience

忍耐

paciência

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STRUCTURE SPOTLIGHT

The same five causative verbs from the reading lab.

CASE	STRUCTURE	MEANING
MAKE	make + object + base verb / adjective	force — no choice
LET	let + object + base verb	permission — full choice
GET	get + object + to + verb	persuade — takes effort
HAVE	have + object + base verb	arrange — it's their role
HELP	help + object + (to) + verb	assist — together

DISCUSSION

No right answer. Use the target verbs if you can.

1. Have you ever been made to wait somewhere and ended up not minding it? What happened?

2. Would you rather stay somewhere with strict check-in times, or somewhere more flexible? Why?

3. What's one thing a hotel or host has done for you that felt like more than just following the rules?

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TRANSCRIPT

For review after class, or for the teacher to read aloud if the audio isn't available.

We arrived at the ryokan two hours before check-in, exhausted from the train. The owner didn't let us into our room, but she got us to leave our bags at the front desk, and made us feel welcome anyway. She had the kitchen prepare tea immediately, and she helped us plan the afternoon so the wait wouldn't feel wasted. By four o'clock, she finally let us in. The room had tatami floors and a view of the garden. That evening, the ryokan made me understand something about patience I hadn't expected from a hotel stay: sometimes being made to wait is the whole point.

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